

# Subspaces

## Geometric Algorithms

# Practice Problem

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 & 2 \\ 2 & 0 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 4 & 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix} \quad \begin{array}{l} R_1 \leftarrow R_1 + R_2 \\ R_3 \leftarrow 2R_3 \\ R_2 \leftrightarrow R_3 \\ \longrightarrow \end{array} \quad \begin{bmatrix} 3 & 0 & 1 & 5 \\ 2 & 8 & 0 & 4 \\ 2 & 0 & 2 & 3 \end{bmatrix} = B$$

*Consider the following pair of matrices  $A$  and  $B$  which are row equivalent. Find a matrix  $E$  such that  $EA = B$*

# Answer

$$R_1 \leftarrow R_1 + R_2$$

$$R_3 \leftarrow 2R_3$$

$$R_2 \leftrightarrow R_3$$

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & -1 & 2 \\ 2 & 0 & 2 & 3 \\ 1 & 4 & 0 & 2 \end{bmatrix}$$

 $\longrightarrow$ 

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# Objectives

- » Introduce the fundamental notions of **subspaces** and **bases**
- » Extend our intuitions about planes in  $\mathbb{R}^3$  to subspaces in  $\mathbb{R}^n$
- » Connected subspaces to matrices so that we can use the techniques we been honing in this course

# Keywords

subspace

closed under addition

closed under scaling

column space

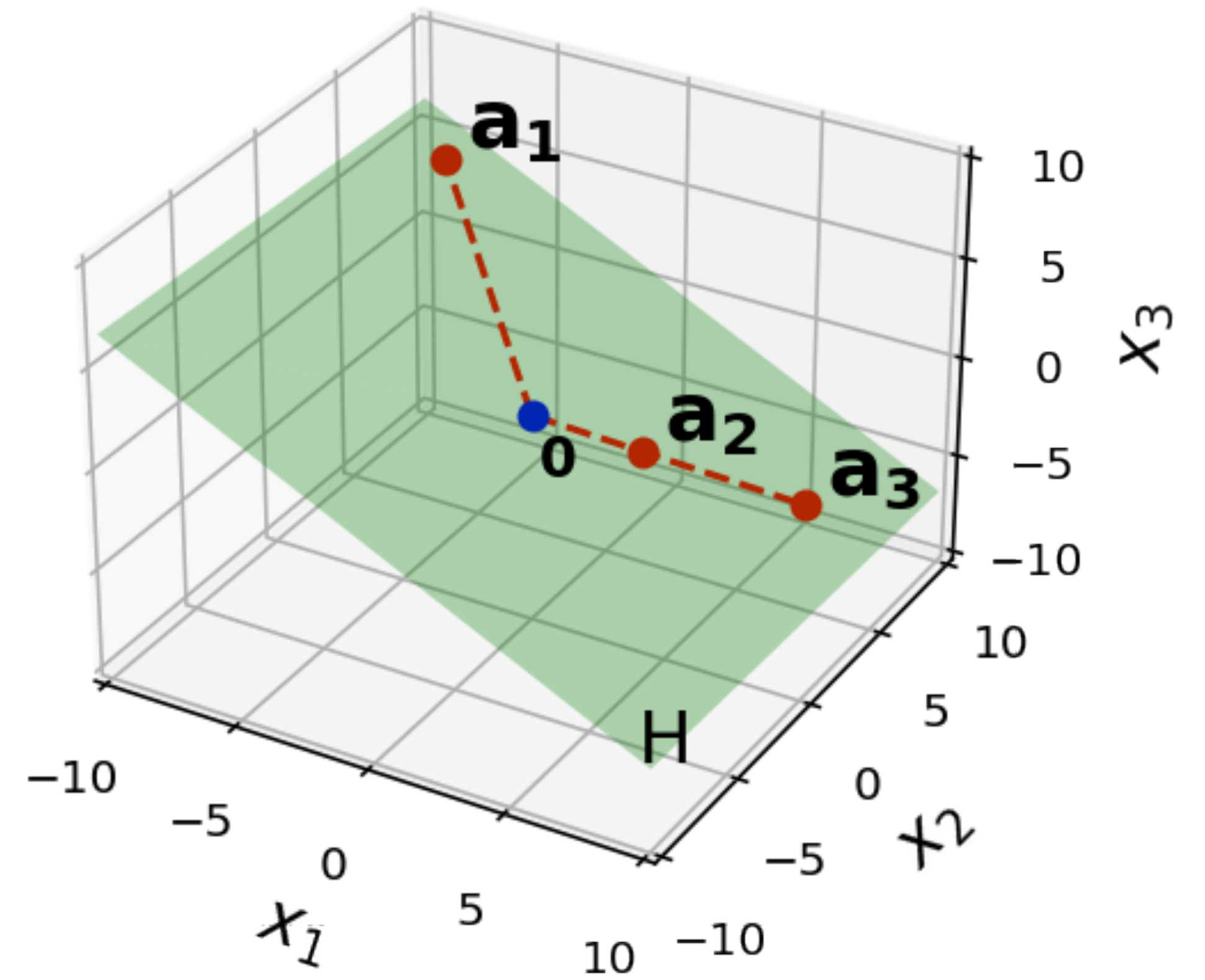
null space

basis

# Subspaces

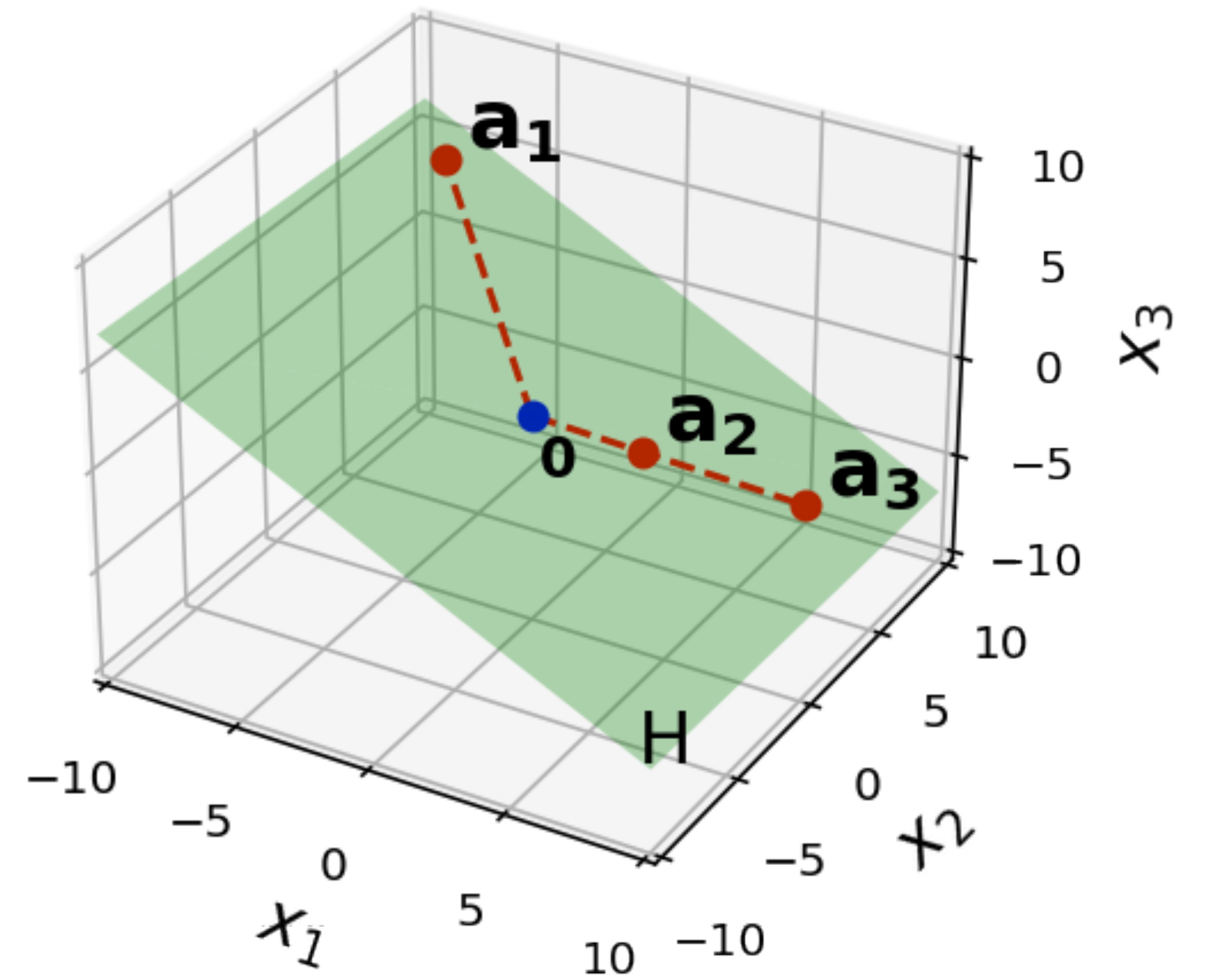


# Subspaces



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"sub" means "part of" or "below"

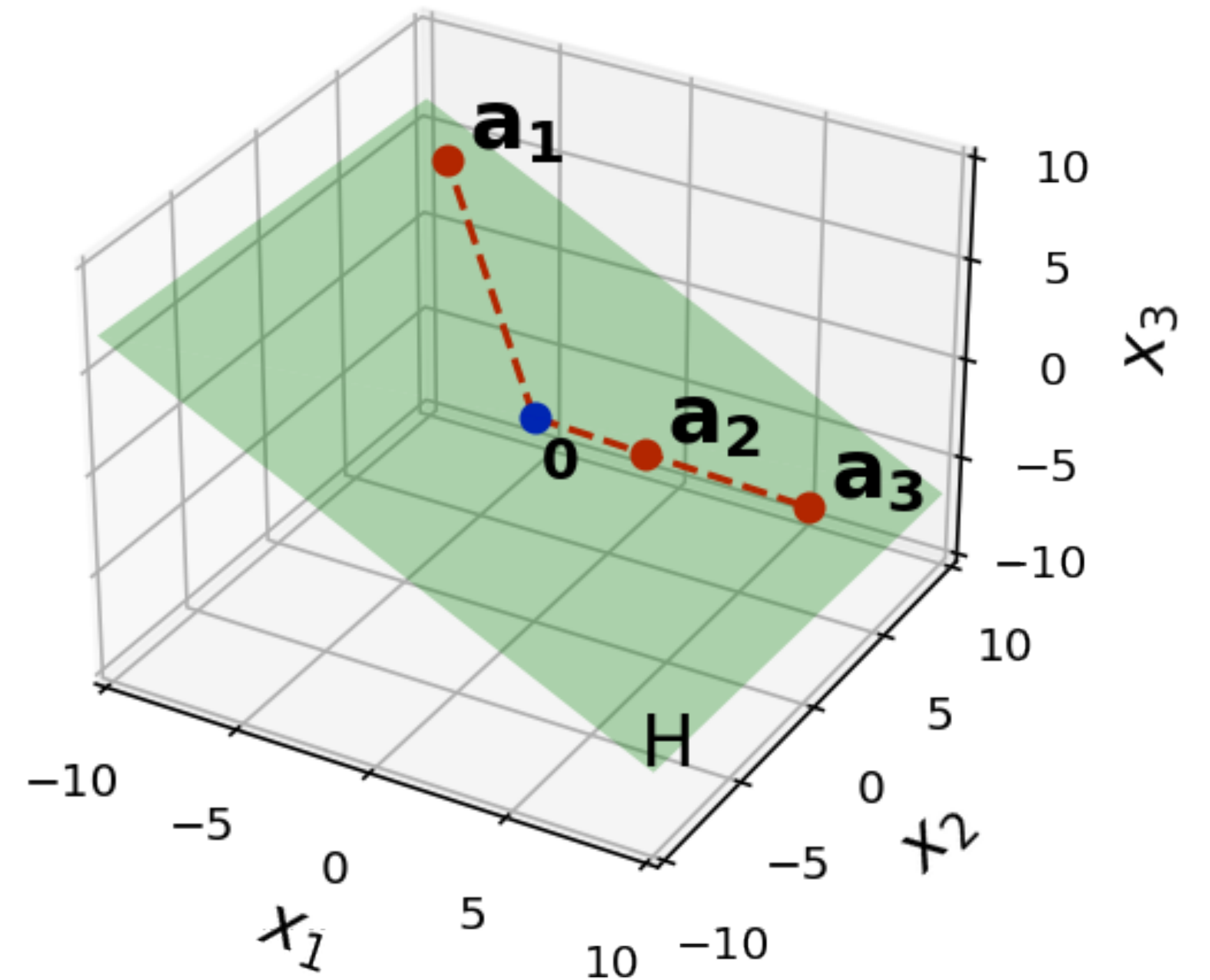




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A plane in  $\mathbb{R}^3$  looks like a tilted copy of  $\mathbb{R}^2$

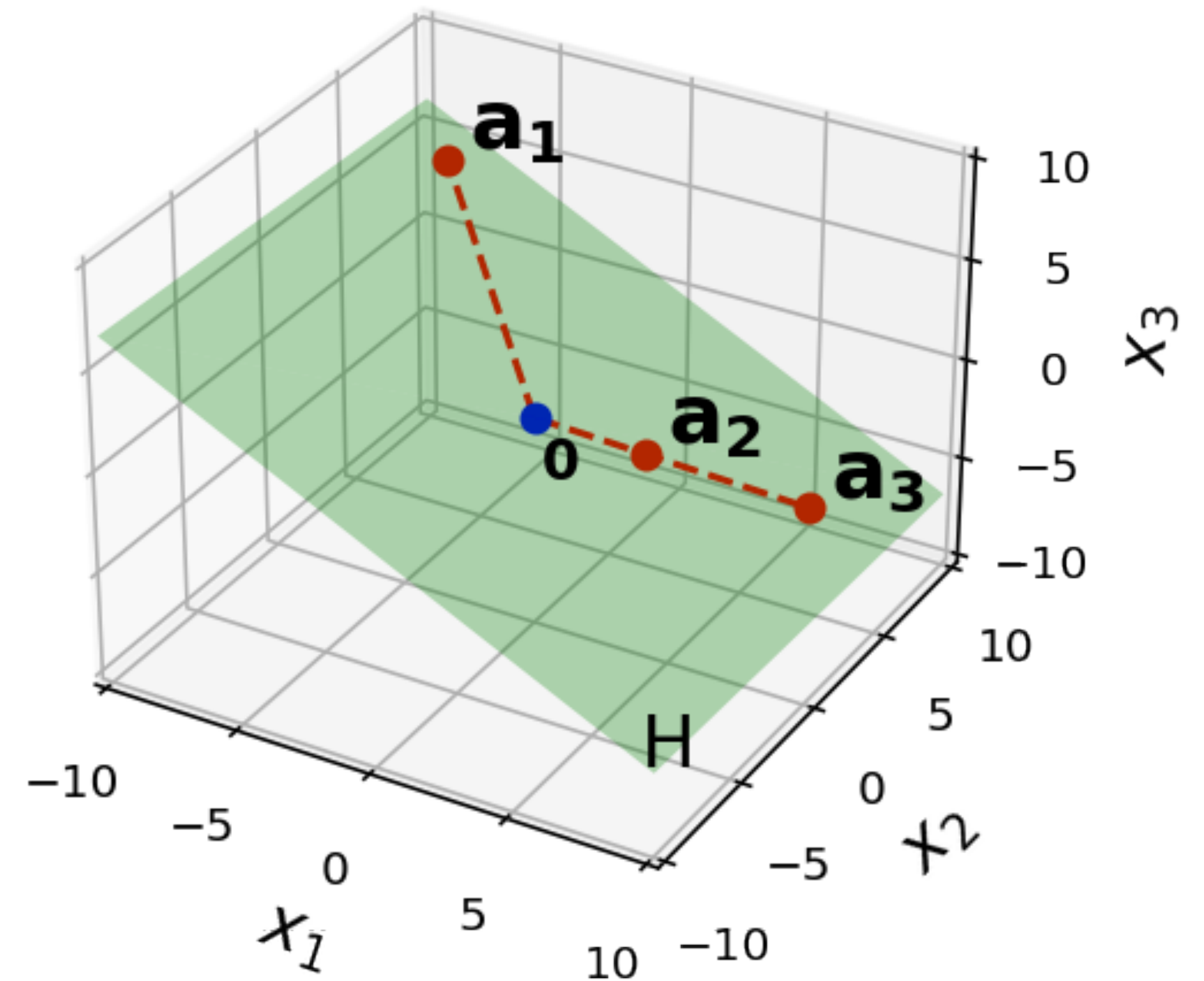


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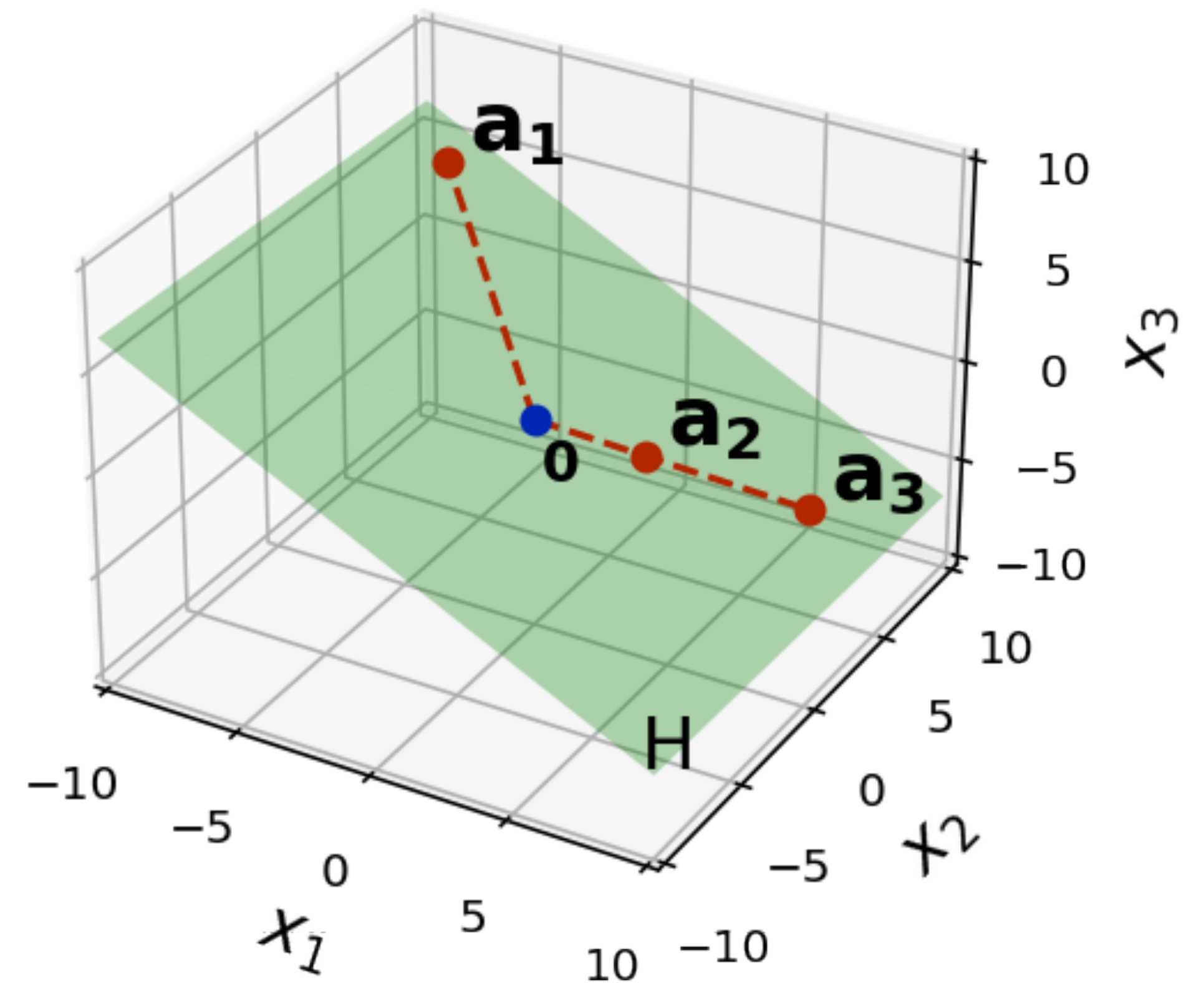
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Subspaces *generalize* this

**Ex.** We can look at "tilted copies" of  $\mathbb{R}^7$  sitting in  $\mathbb{R}^{11}$





# **An Aside: Flatland, Relativity, Higher Dimensions**

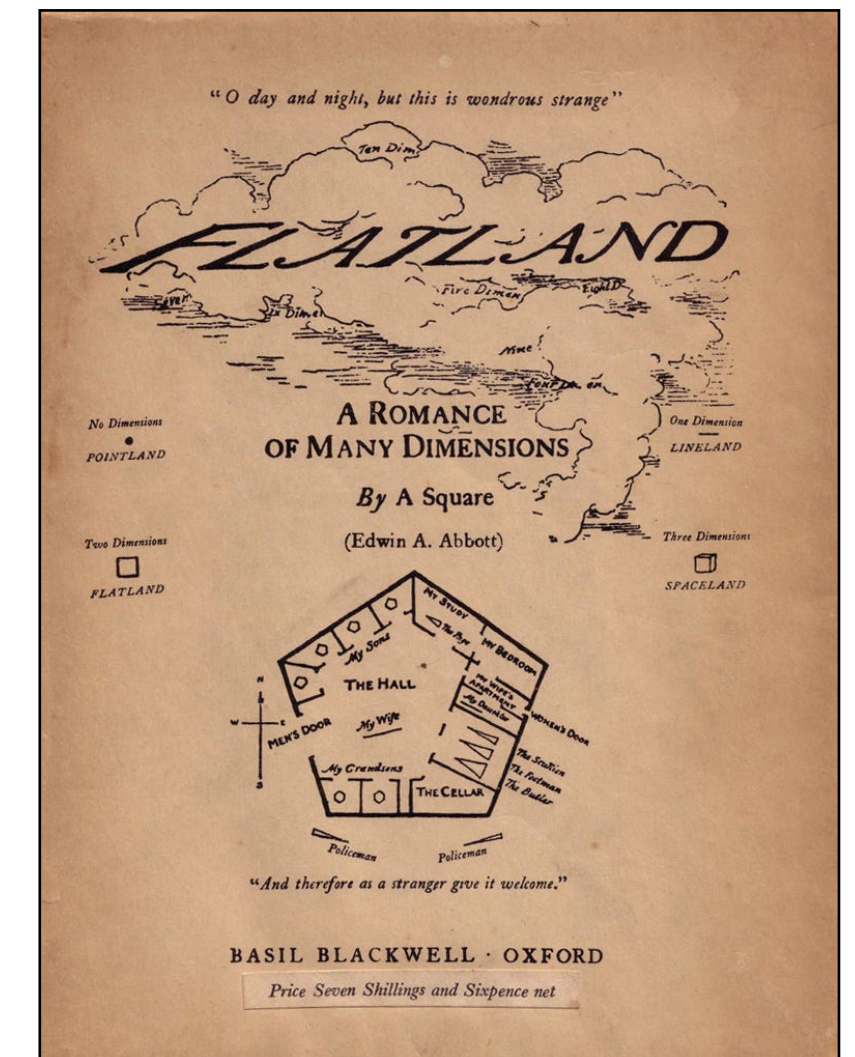
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Flatland by Edwin A. Abbott

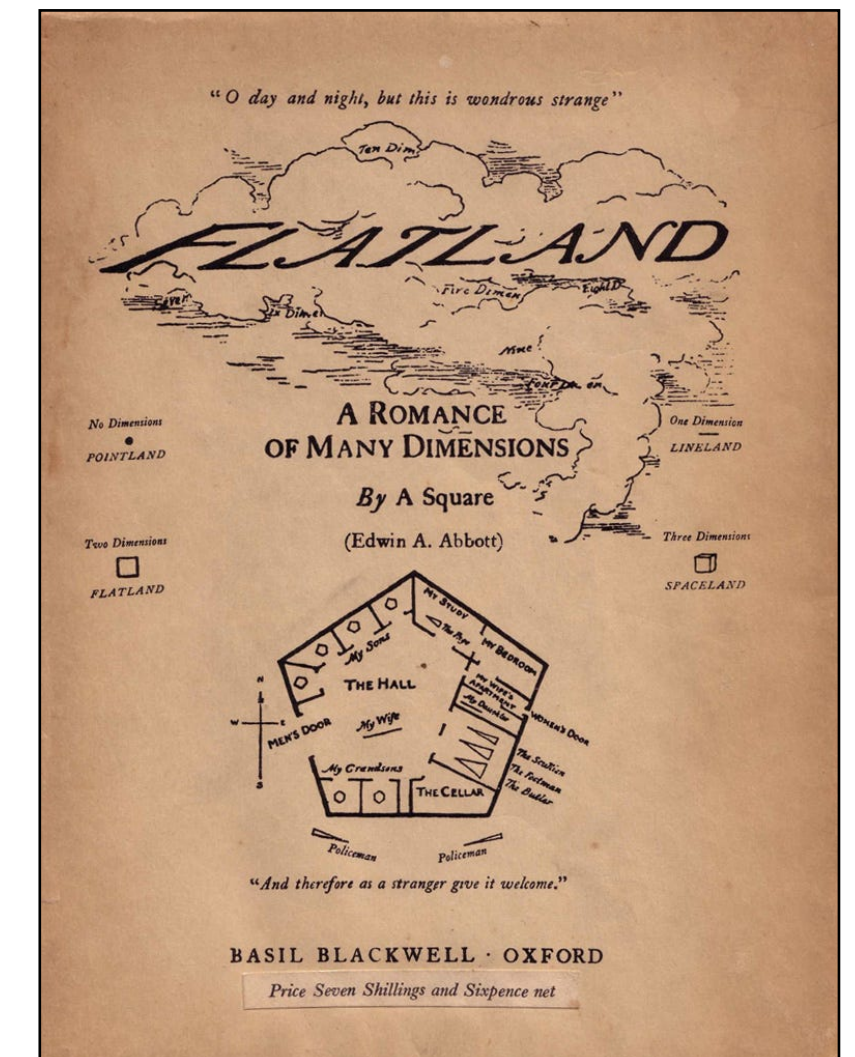


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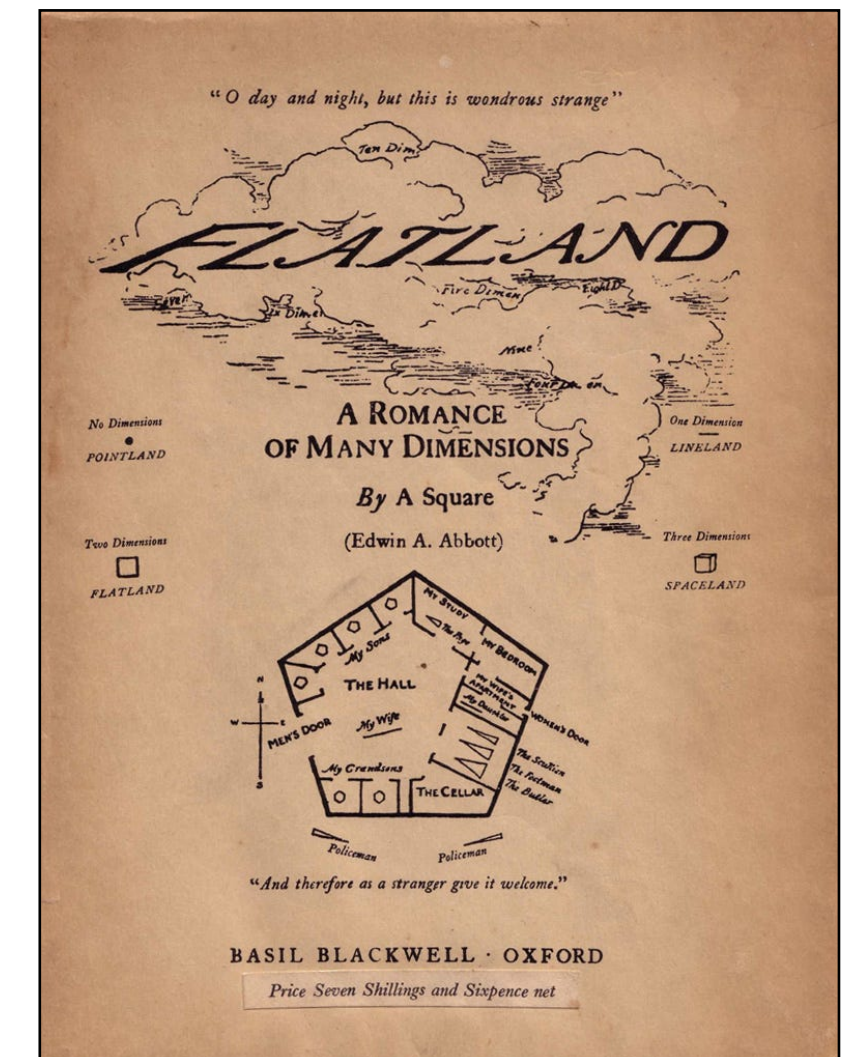
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**The moral.** We have to be careful about our intuitions about higher-dimensional subspaces



Flatland by Edwin A. Abbott





# Subspace (Algebraic Definition)

**Definition.** A subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^n$  is a set  $H$  of vectors in  $\mathbb{R}^n$  such that

1. for every  $\mathbf{u}$  and  $\mathbf{v}$  in  $H$ , the vector  $\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}$  is in  $H$
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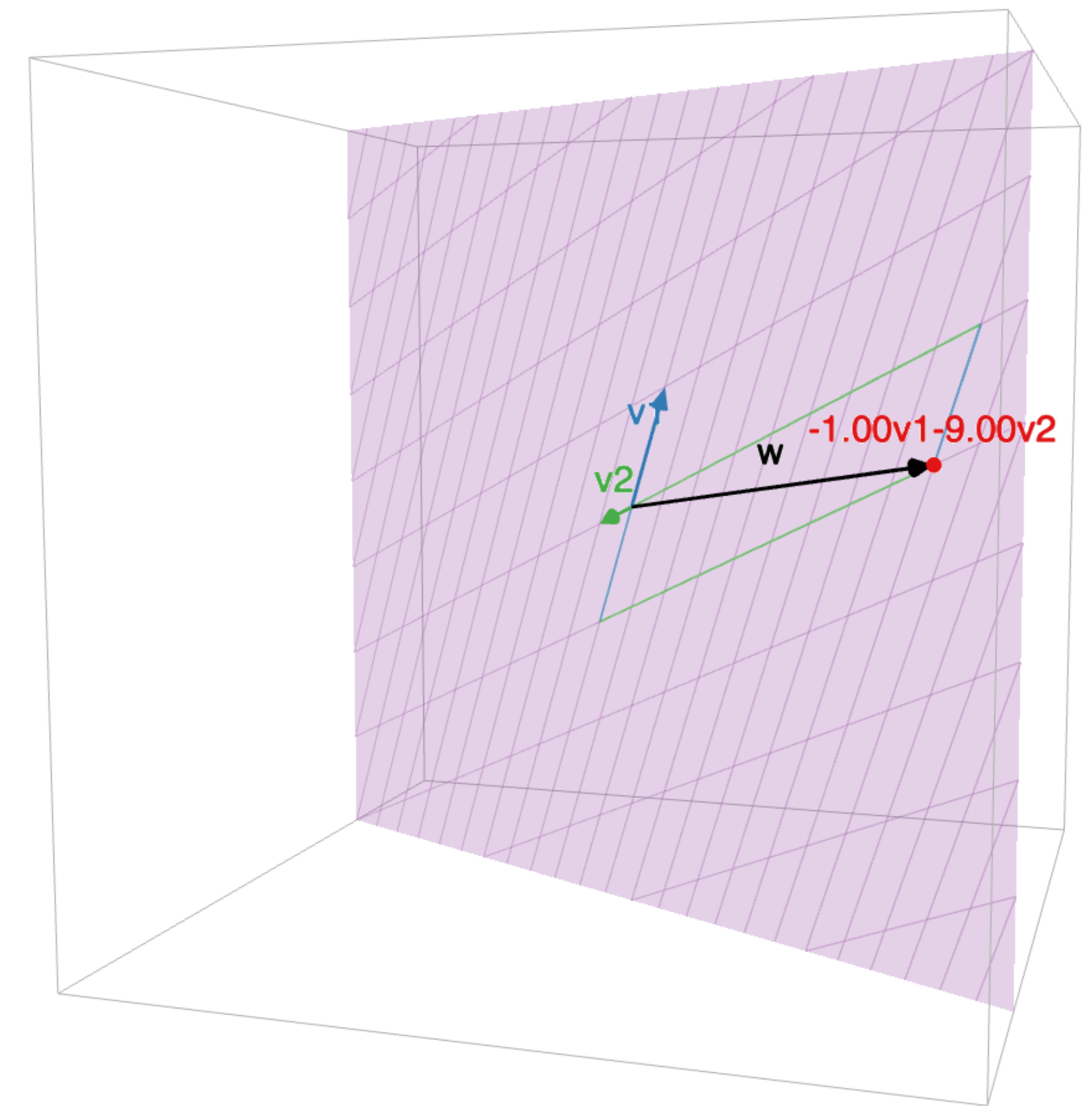
2. for every  $\mathbf{u}$  in  $H$  and scalar  $c$ , the vector  $c\mathbf{u}$  is in  $H$   **$H$  is closed under scaling**

**!! Subspaces must "live" somewhere !!**

# How to Think About this

It's not possible to "leave"  $H$   
by addition or scaling

(recall this is also how we discussed spans)



# How To: Verifying Subspaces



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2. Show if  $\mathbf{u}$  is in  $H$  then so is  $c\mathbf{u}$  for any scalar  $c$

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Find  $\mathbf{u}$  and  $\mathbf{v}$  in  $H$  where  $\mathbf{u} + \mathbf{v}$  is not in  $H$

*or*

Find  $\mathbf{u}$  in  $H$  where  $c\mathbf{u}$  is not in  $H$  for *some* scalar  $c$



# Lines in $\mathbb{R}^2$



# Subspaces must include the origin

**Fact.** For any subspace  $H$  of  $\mathbb{R}^n$ , the zero vector is in  $H$ . In set notation:  $\mathbf{0} \in H$

(this can also be used to verify non-subspace-ness)

# Example: The Origin

**Fact.** The set  $\{\mathbf{0}_n\}$  is a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^n$

**Example:**  $\mathbb{R}^n$

**Fact.** The set  $\mathbb{R}^n$  is a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^n$



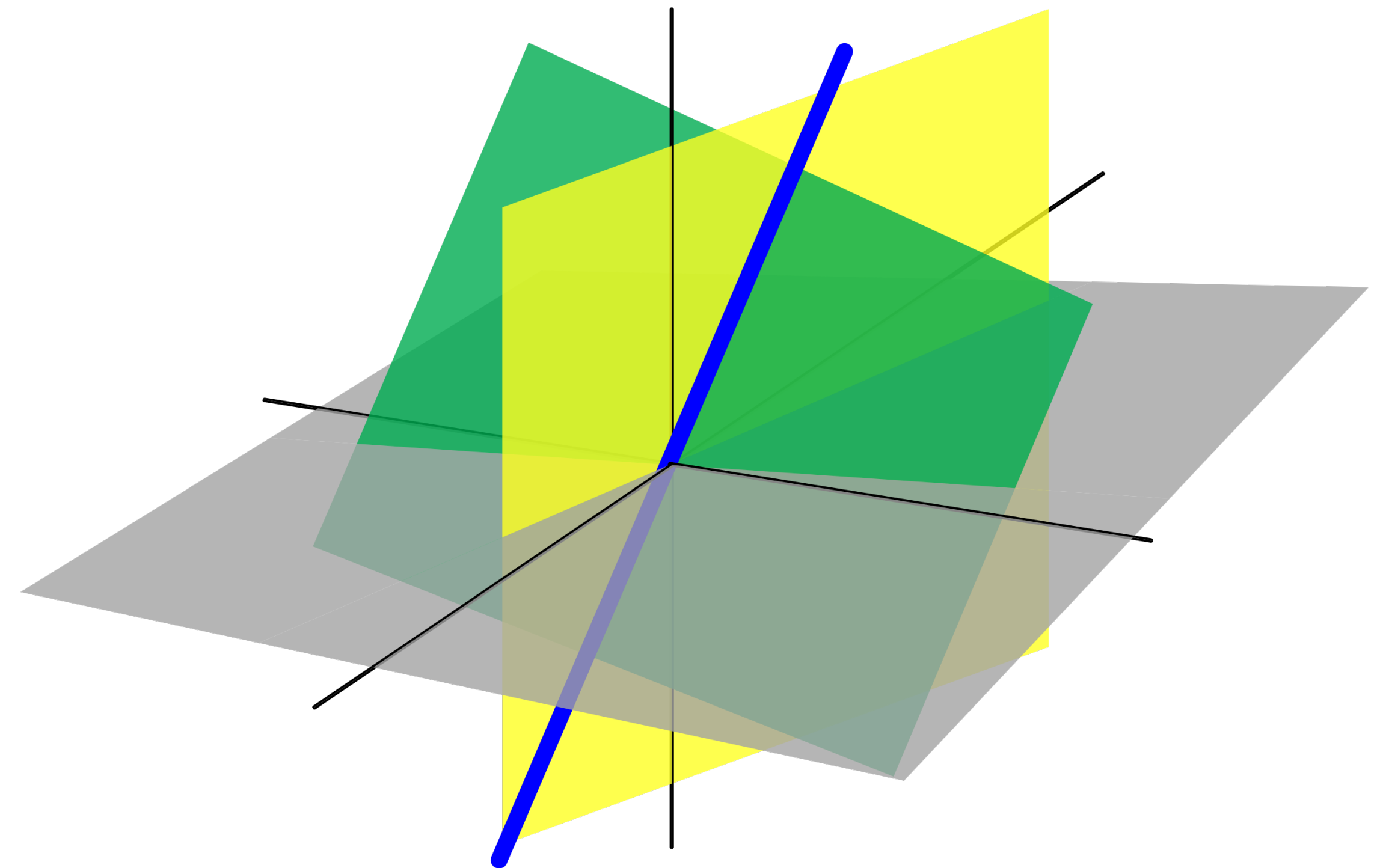
# Example: Spans

**Fact.** For any set of vectors  $\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$  the set  $\text{span}\{\mathbf{v}_1, \mathbf{v}_2, \dots, \mathbf{v}_n\}$  is a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^n$

# Subspace in $\mathbb{R}^3$ (Geometrically)

There are only 4 kinds of subspaces of  $\mathbb{R}^3$ :

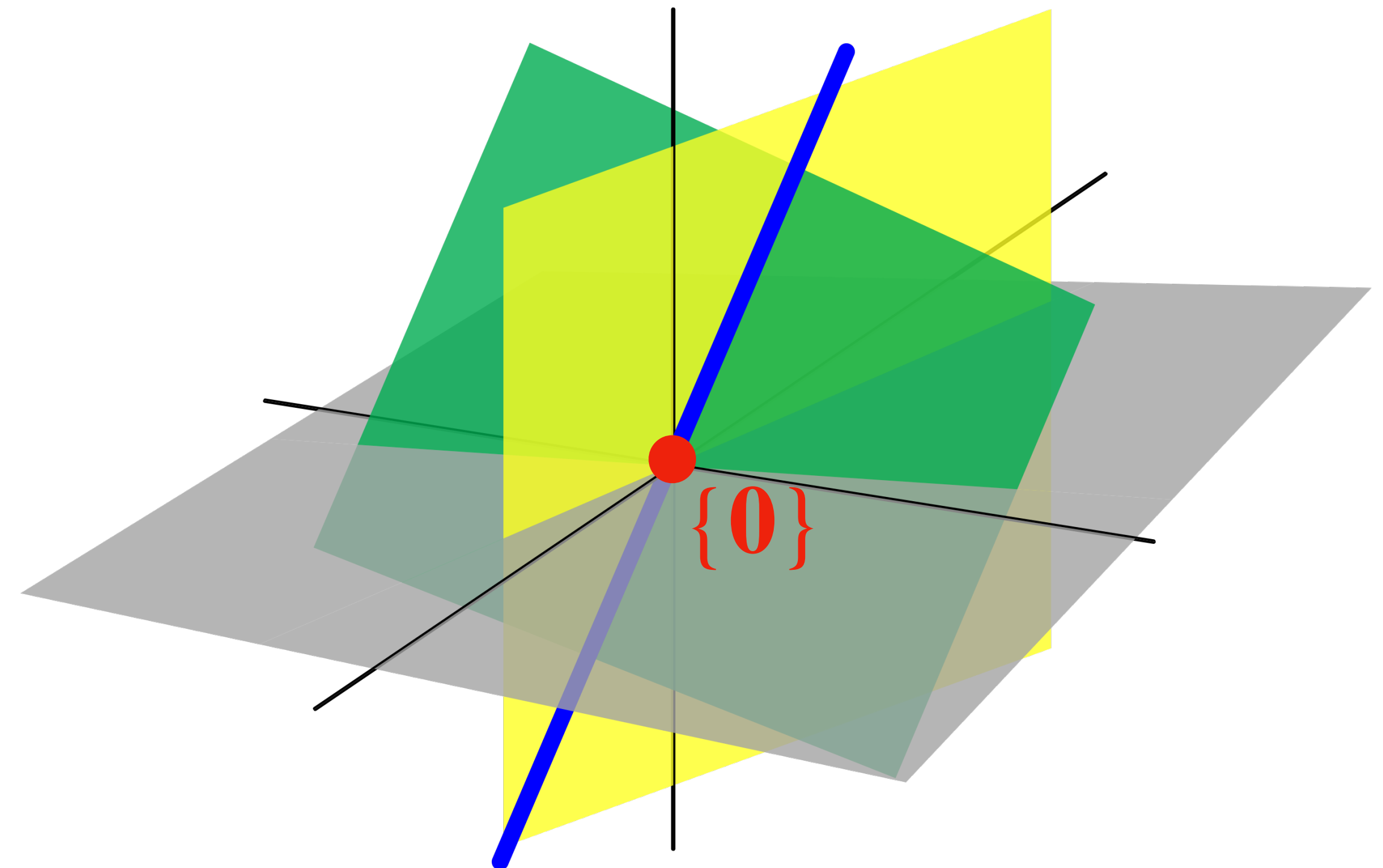
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2. lines (through the origin)
3. planes (through the origin)
4. All of  $\mathbb{R}^3$



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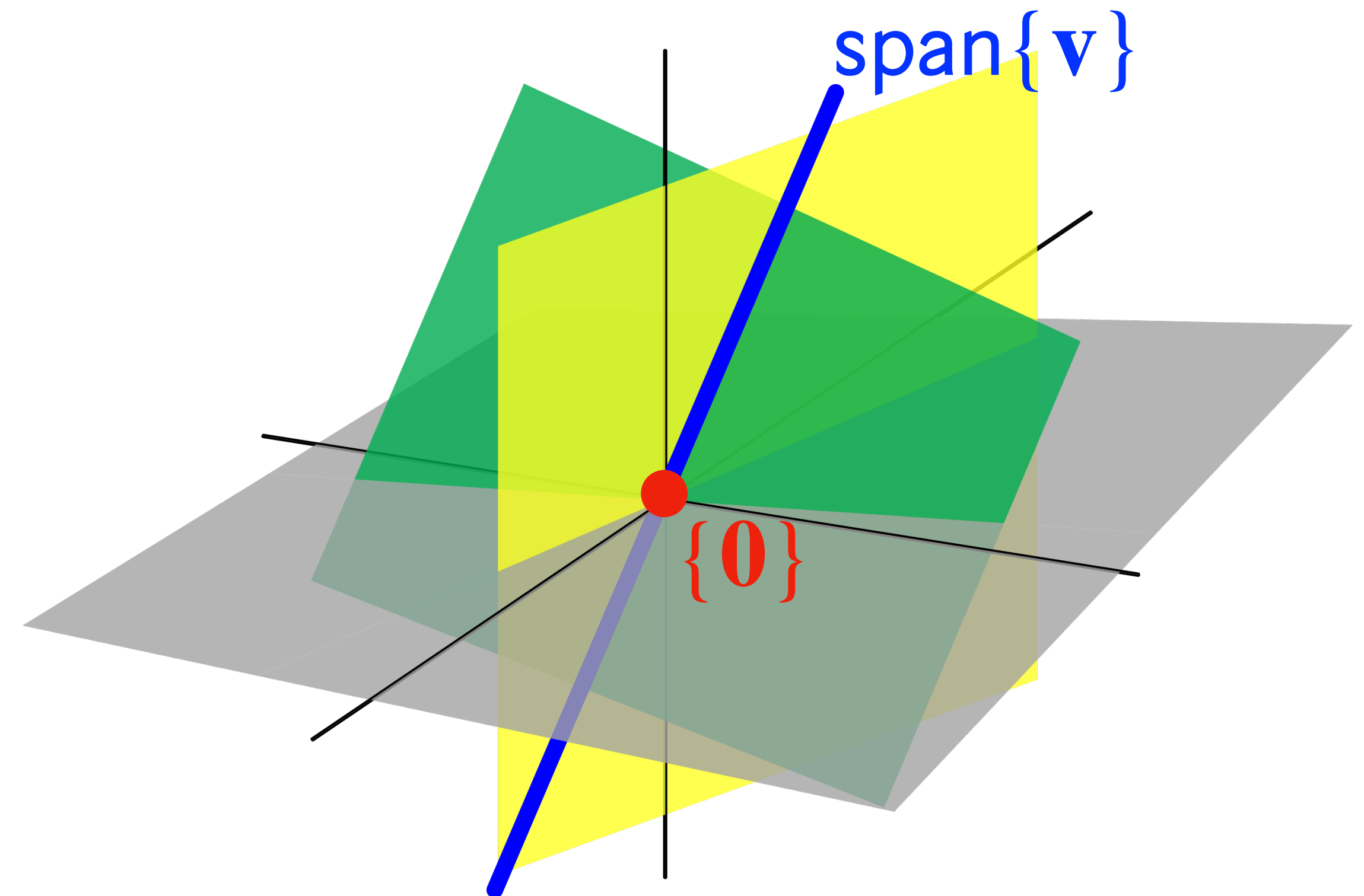




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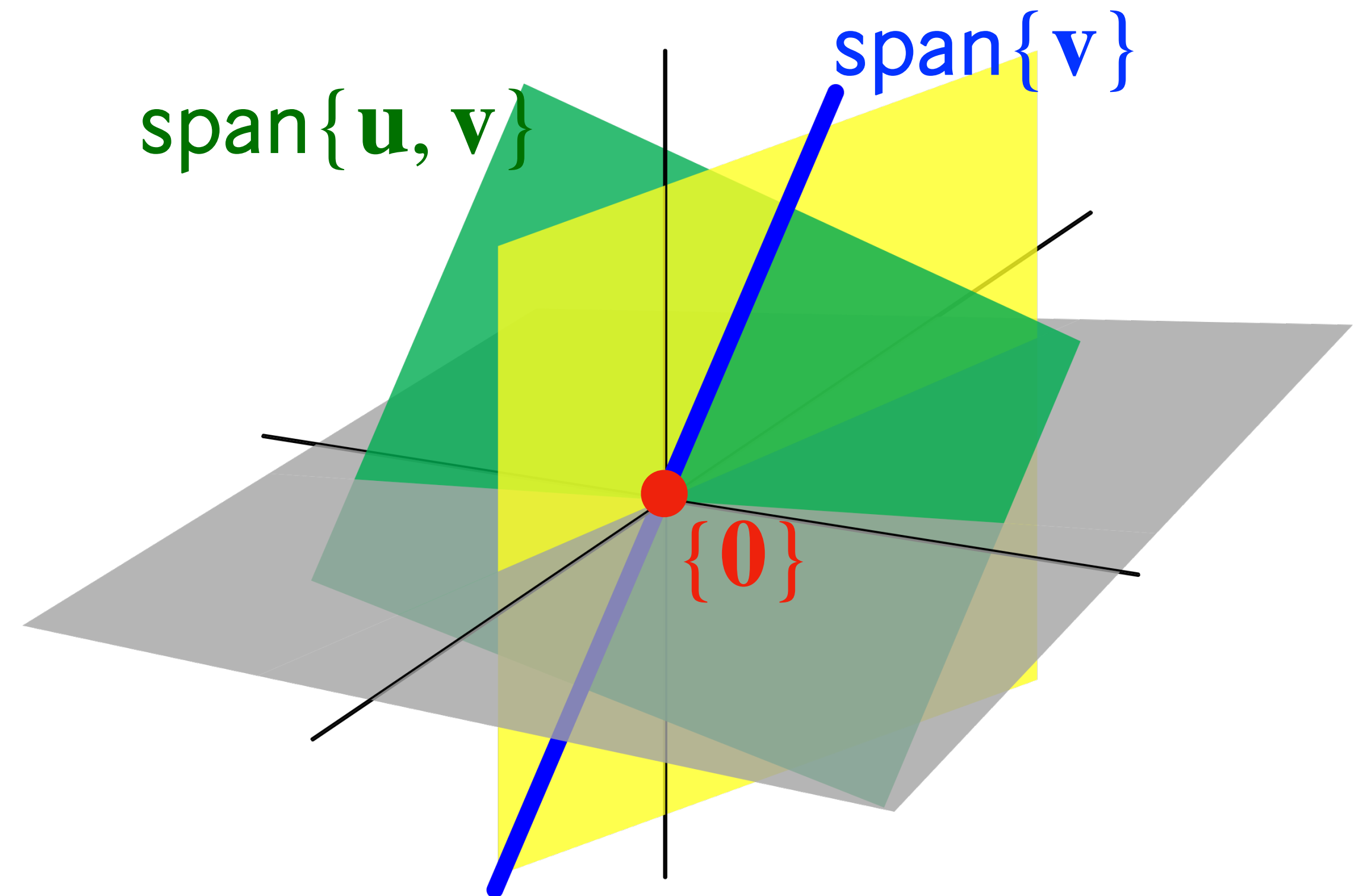
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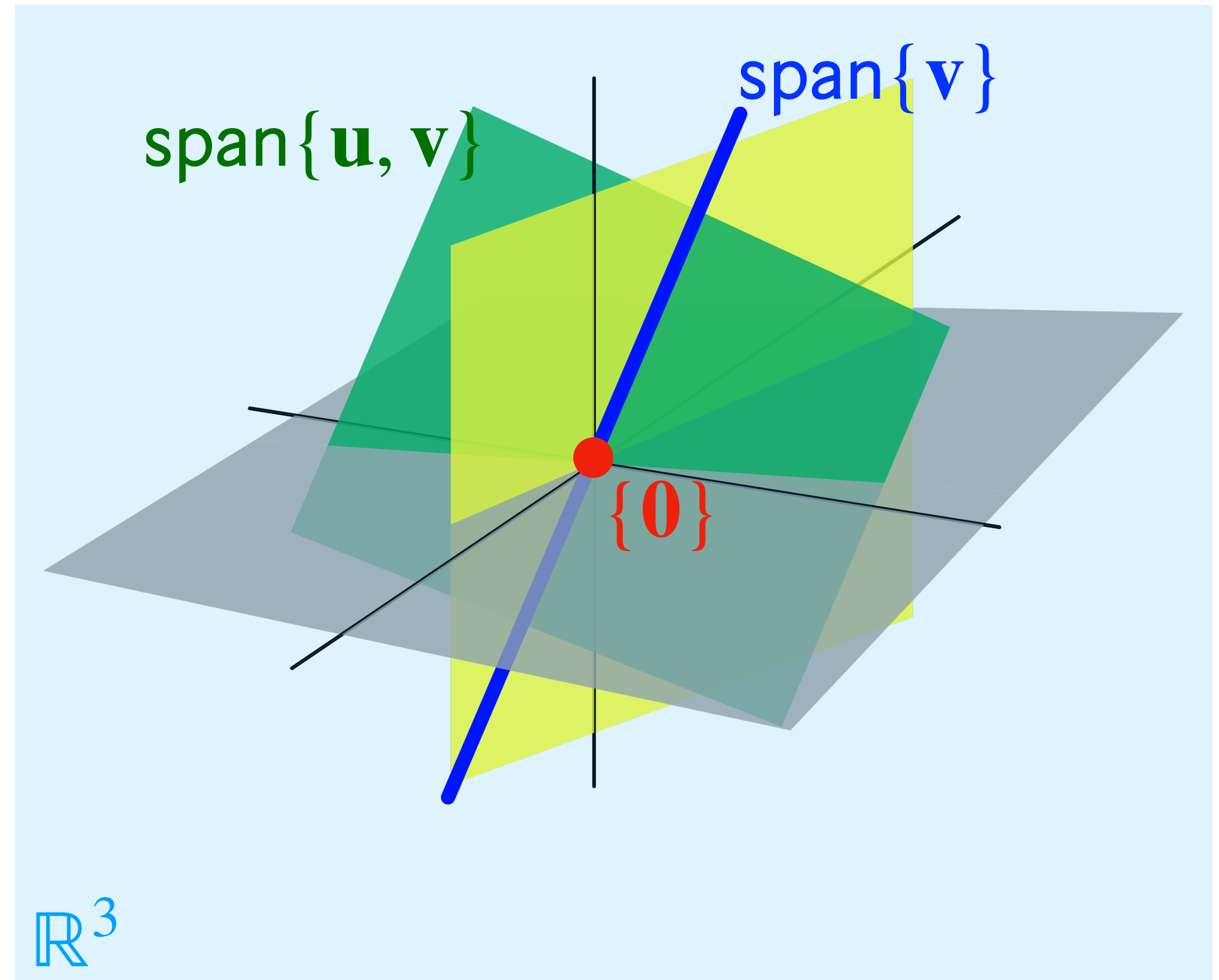




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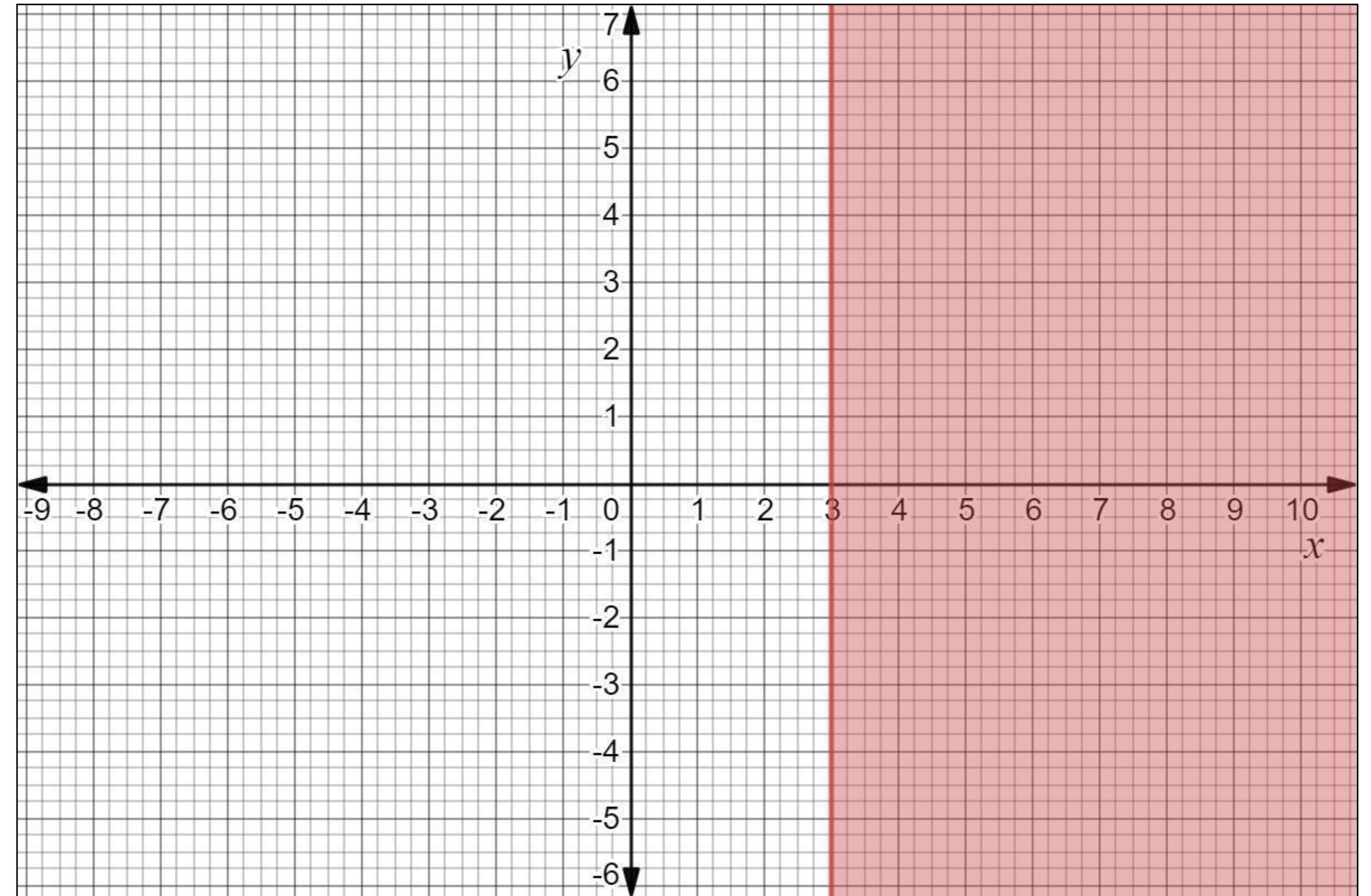
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# Non-Example: Bounded Sets

**Fact.** The set  $\{(x, y) : x \geq 3\}$  is *not* a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^2$



# Question

- 1. Show that the unit sphere  $\{(x, y, z) : x^2 + y^2 + x^2 = 1\}$  is not a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^3$*
- 2. Show that the range of a linear transformation  $T : \mathbb{R}^m \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^n$  is a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^n$*



**Answer (1)**

# Answer (2)

# How To: Subspaces and Span

**Q.** Show that  $\mathbf{v}$  lies in the subspace generated by  $\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_k$

**A.** Show that  $\mathbf{v}$  is in  $\text{span}\{\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_k\}$

We will start using "subspace generated by"  
and "span of" interchangeably



# Subspaces and Matrices

# The Connection

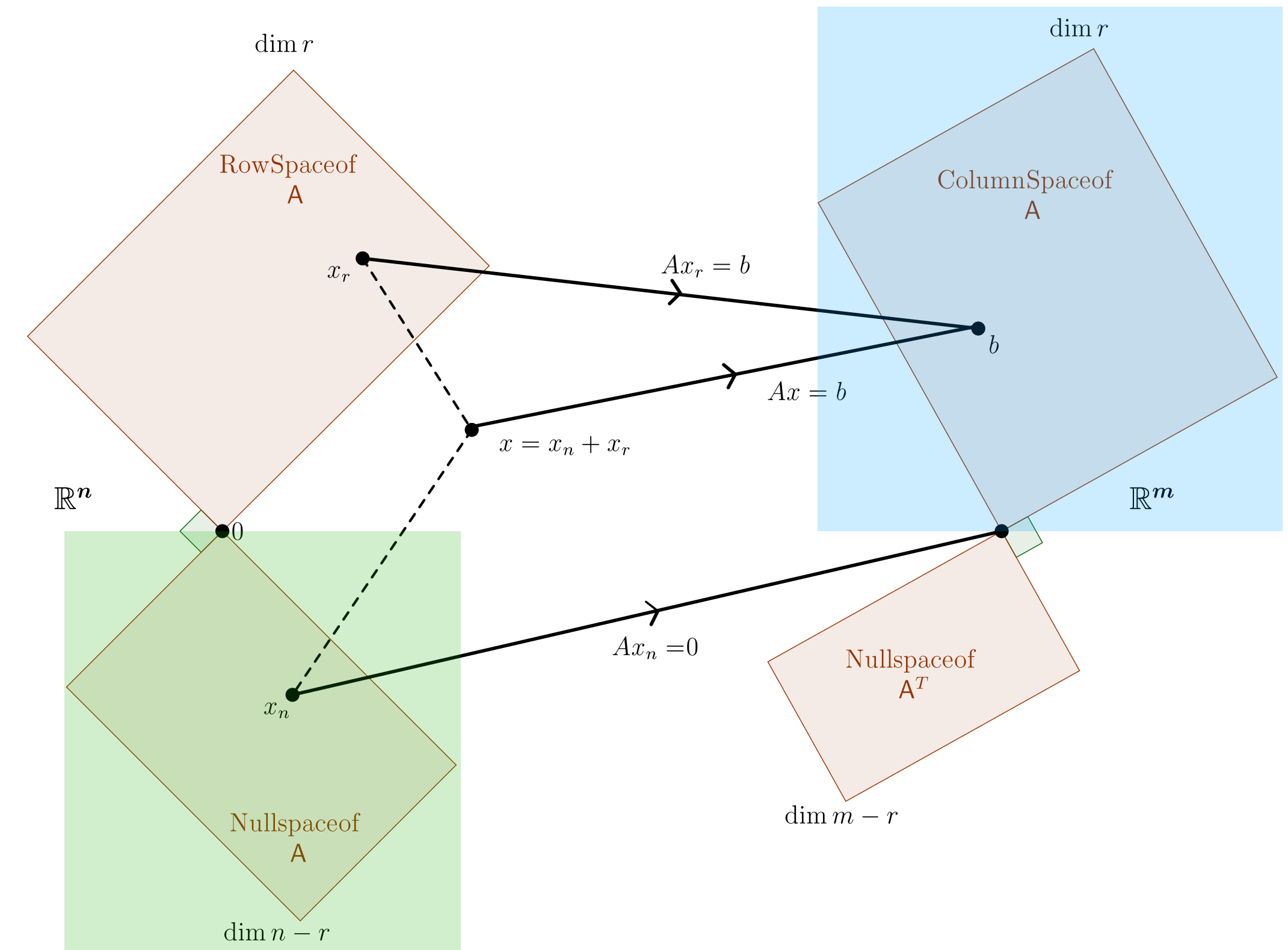
Since matrices can be viewed as:

- » collections of vectors
- » implementing linear transformations

they have many associated subspaces

Today we'll look at:

- » column space
- » null space





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**Df.** *The column space of a matrix is the span of its columns*

**Df.** *The column space of a matrix is the range of the linear transformation it implements*

# Subspace of What?

$$m \left| \begin{array}{ccccc} & & n & & \\ \hline & & & & \\ \mathbf{a}_1 & \mathbf{a}_2 & \cdots & \mathbf{a}_{n-1} & \mathbf{a}_n \\ & & & & \\ & & & & \end{array} \right]$$

$c_1\mathbf{a}_1 + c_2\mathbf{a}_2 + \dots c_n\mathbf{a}_n$  **is a**  
**vector in  $\mathbb{R}^m$**

$\text{Col}(A)$

is a subspace of

$\mathbb{R}^m$

# Examples

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 1 \\ 0 & 2 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

$$B = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -1 & 4 \\ 2 & -2 & 5 \\ 3 & -3 & 6 \end{bmatrix}$$



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**The null space of a matrix  $A$  is the set of all vectors that are mapped to the zero vector by  $A$**

# Subspace of What?

$$\begin{array}{c} \text{rows } m \\ \left| \begin{array}{c} \overbrace{A}^{n \text{ columns}} \\ \mathbf{v} \end{array} \right. = \mathbf{0} \\ \begin{array}{cc} m \times n & n \times 1 \end{array} \qquad \begin{array}{c} m \times 1 \end{array} \end{array}$$

**v** is a vector  
in  $\mathbb{R}^n$

$\text{Nul}(A)$

is a subspace of

$\mathbb{R}^n$

# The Null Space is a Subspace

**Fact.** For any  $m \times n$  matrix  $A$ , the set  $\text{Nul}(A)$  is a subspace of  $\mathbb{R}^n$

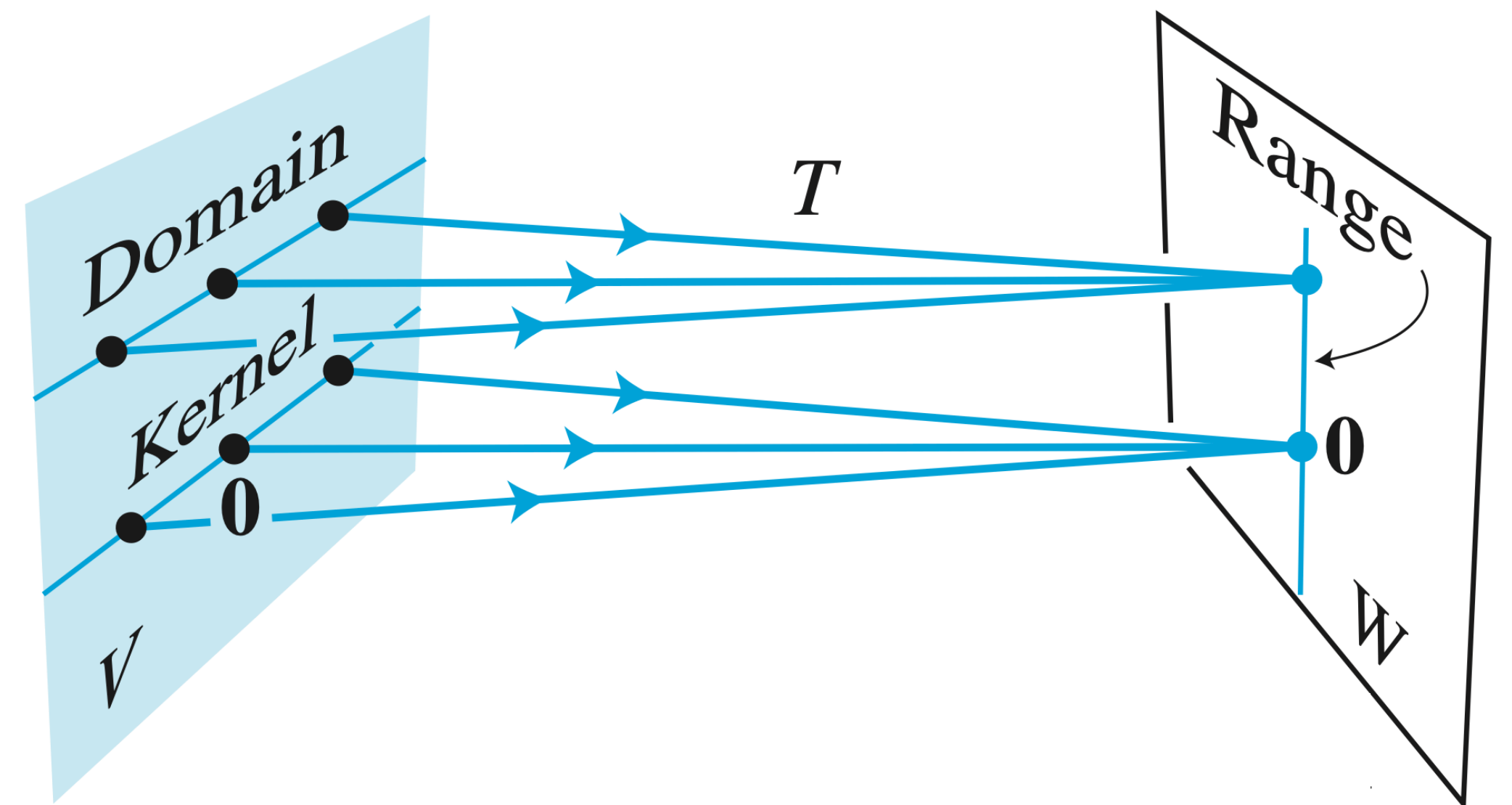


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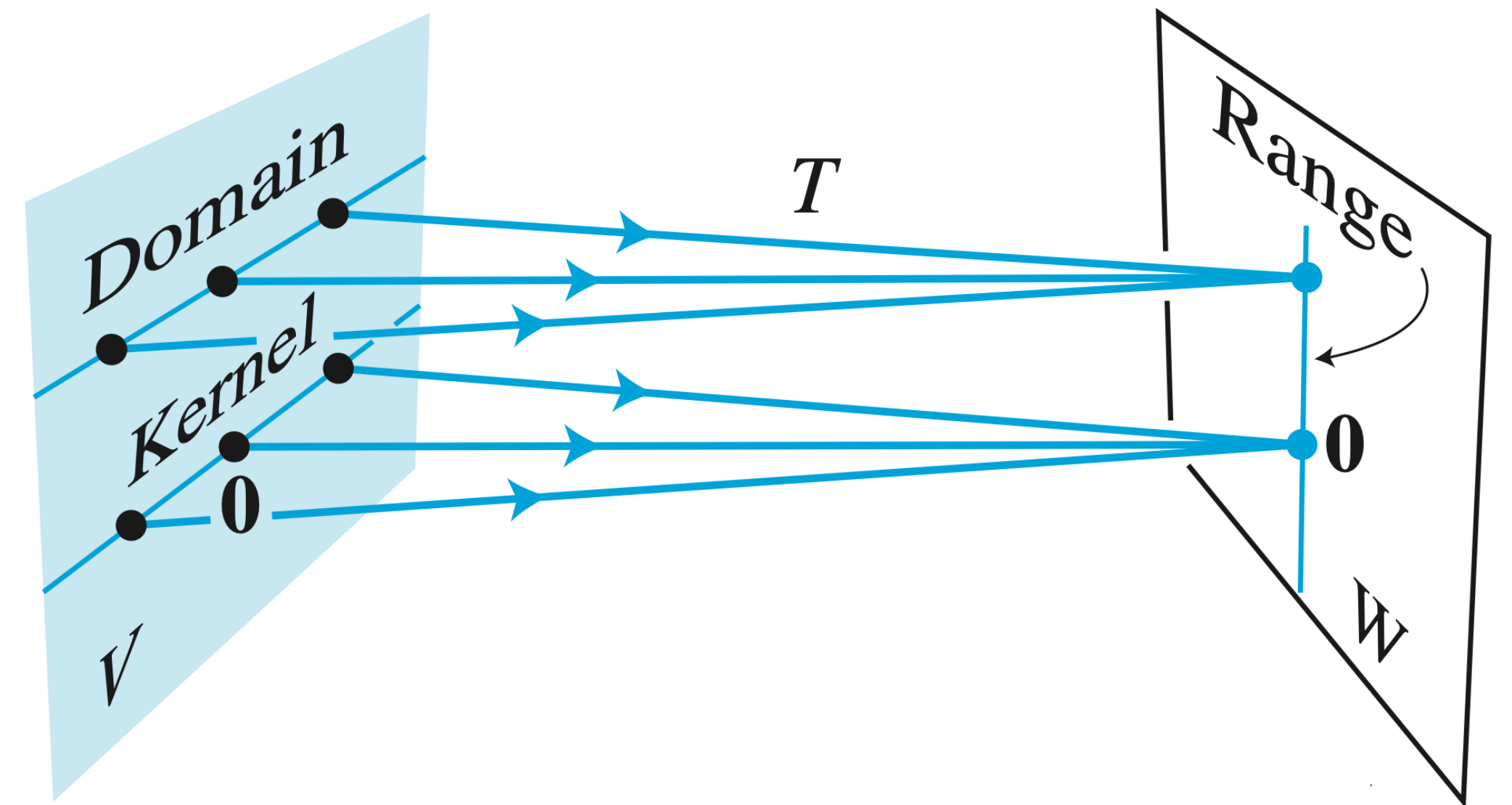
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If  $A$  implements  $T$  then

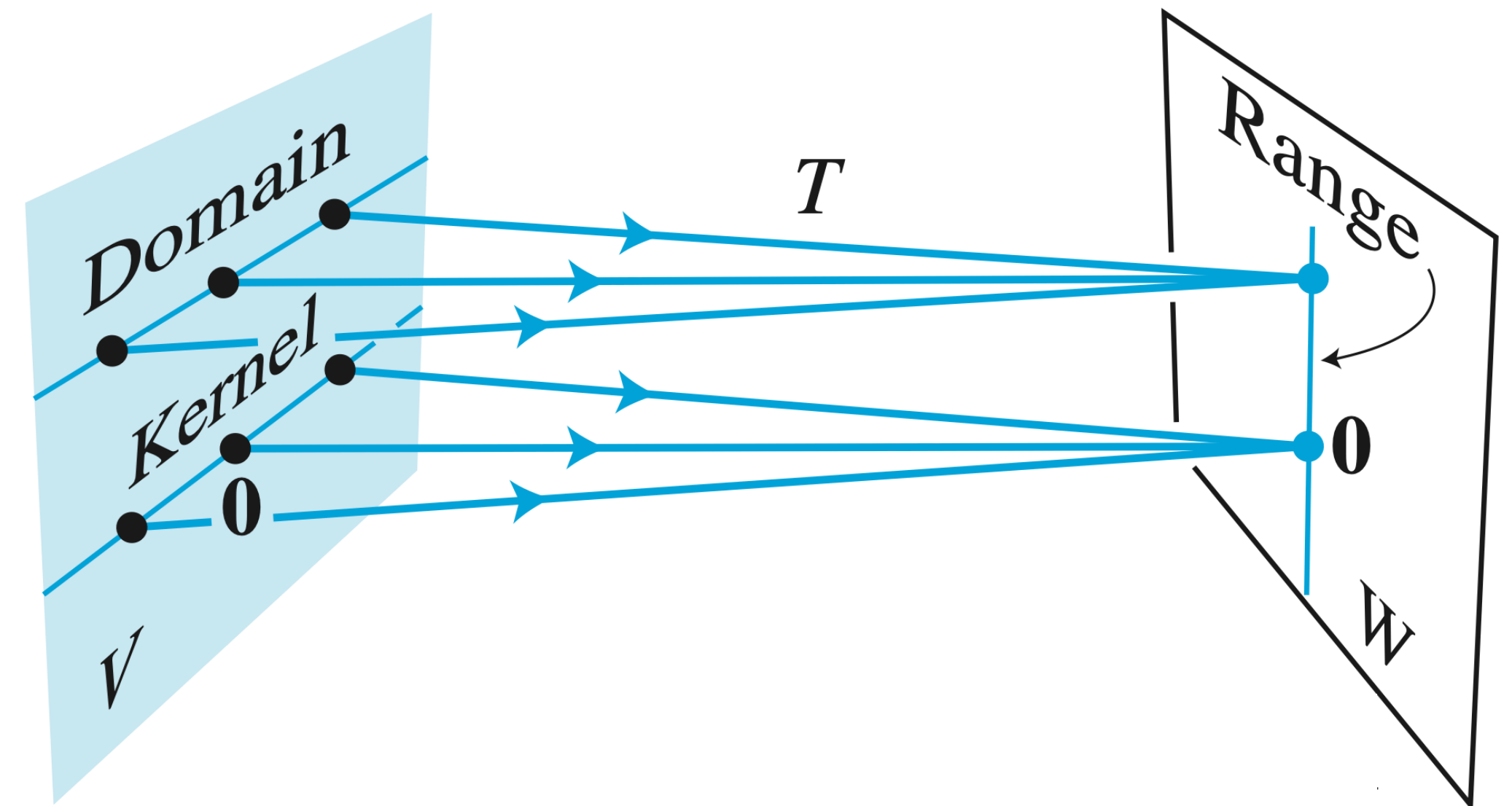




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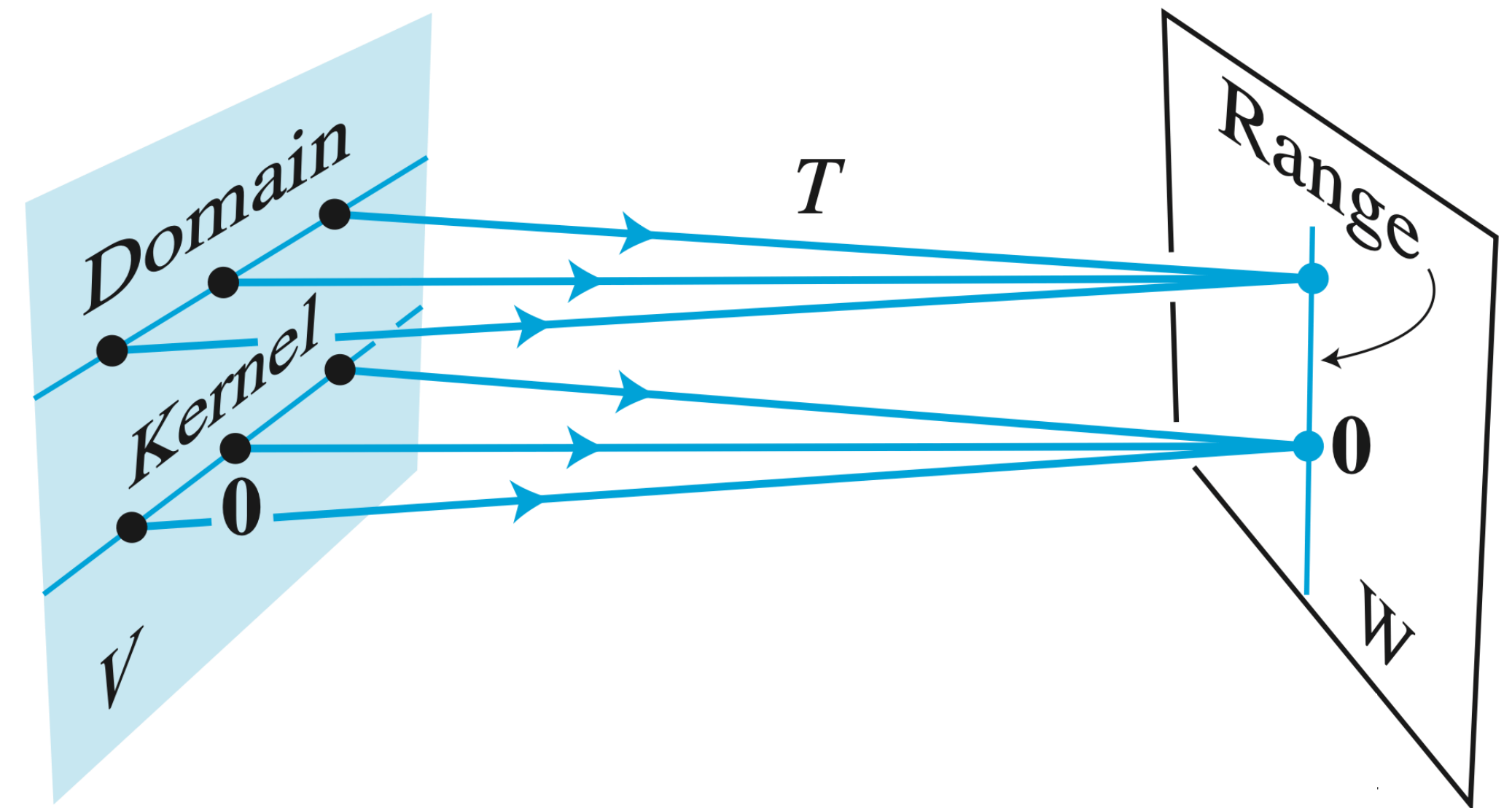
»  $\text{Col}(A)$  is the same as  $\text{ran}(T)$ ,  
where vectors are "sent"  
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# Linear Transformations Perspective

If  $A$  implements  $T$  then

- »  $\text{Col}(A)$  is the same as  $\text{ran}(T)$ , where vectors are "sent" by  $T$
- »  $\text{Nul}(A)$  is the set of vectors that are "zeroed out" by  $T$ , also called the **kernel** of  $T$





# Comparing Column Space and Null Space

The column space and the null space live in entirely different spaces

The point. They are not easily comparable

Contrast Between Nul  $A$  and Col  $A$  for an  $m \times n$  Matrix  $A$

| Nul $A$                                                                                                                                        | Col $A$                                                                                                                                               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1. Nul $A$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^n$ .                                                                                                   | 1. Col $A$ is a subspace of $\mathbb{R}^m$ .                                                                                                          |
| 2. Nul $A$ is implicitly defined; that is, you are given only a condition ( $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$ ) that vectors in Nul $A$ must satisfy. | 2. Col $A$ is explicitly defined; that is, you are told how to build vectors in Col $A$ .                                                             |
| 3. It takes time to find vectors in Nul $A$ . Row operations on $[A \ \mathbf{0}]$ are required.                                               | 3. It is easy to find vectors in Col $A$ . The columns of $A$ are displayed; others are formed from them.                                             |
| 4. There is no obvious relation between Nul $A$ and the entries in $A$ .                                                                       | 4. There is an obvious relation between Col $A$ and the entries in $A$ , since each column of $A$ is in Col $A$ .                                     |
| 5. A typical vector $\mathbf{v}$ in Nul $A$ has the property that $A\mathbf{v} = \mathbf{0}$ .                                                 | 5. A typical vector $\mathbf{v}$ in Col $A$ has the property that the equation $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{v}$ is consistent.                              |
| 6. Given a specific vector $\mathbf{v}$ , it is easy to tell if $\mathbf{v}$ is in Nul $A$ . Just compute $A\mathbf{v}$ .                      | 6. Given a specific vector $\mathbf{v}$ , it may take time to tell if $\mathbf{v}$ is in Col $A$ . Row operations on $[A \ \mathbf{v}]$ are required. |
| 7. Nul $A = \{\mathbf{0}\}$ if and only if the equation $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$ has only the trivial solution.                              | 7. Col $A = \mathbb{R}^m$ if and only if the equation $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{b}$ has a solution for every $\mathbf{b}$ in $\mathbb{R}^m$ .            |
| 8. Nul $A = \{\mathbf{0}\}$ if and only if the linear transformation $\mathbf{x} \mapsto A\mathbf{x}$ is one-to-one.                           | 8. Col $A = \mathbb{R}^m$ if and only if the linear transformation $\mathbf{x} \mapsto A\mathbf{x}$ maps $\mathbb{R}^n$ onto $\mathbb{R}^m$ .         |

*(just for reference)*

# Bases

# The idea behind a basis



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*A basis is a "minimal" choice of these vectors,  
a "concise representation" of a subspace*

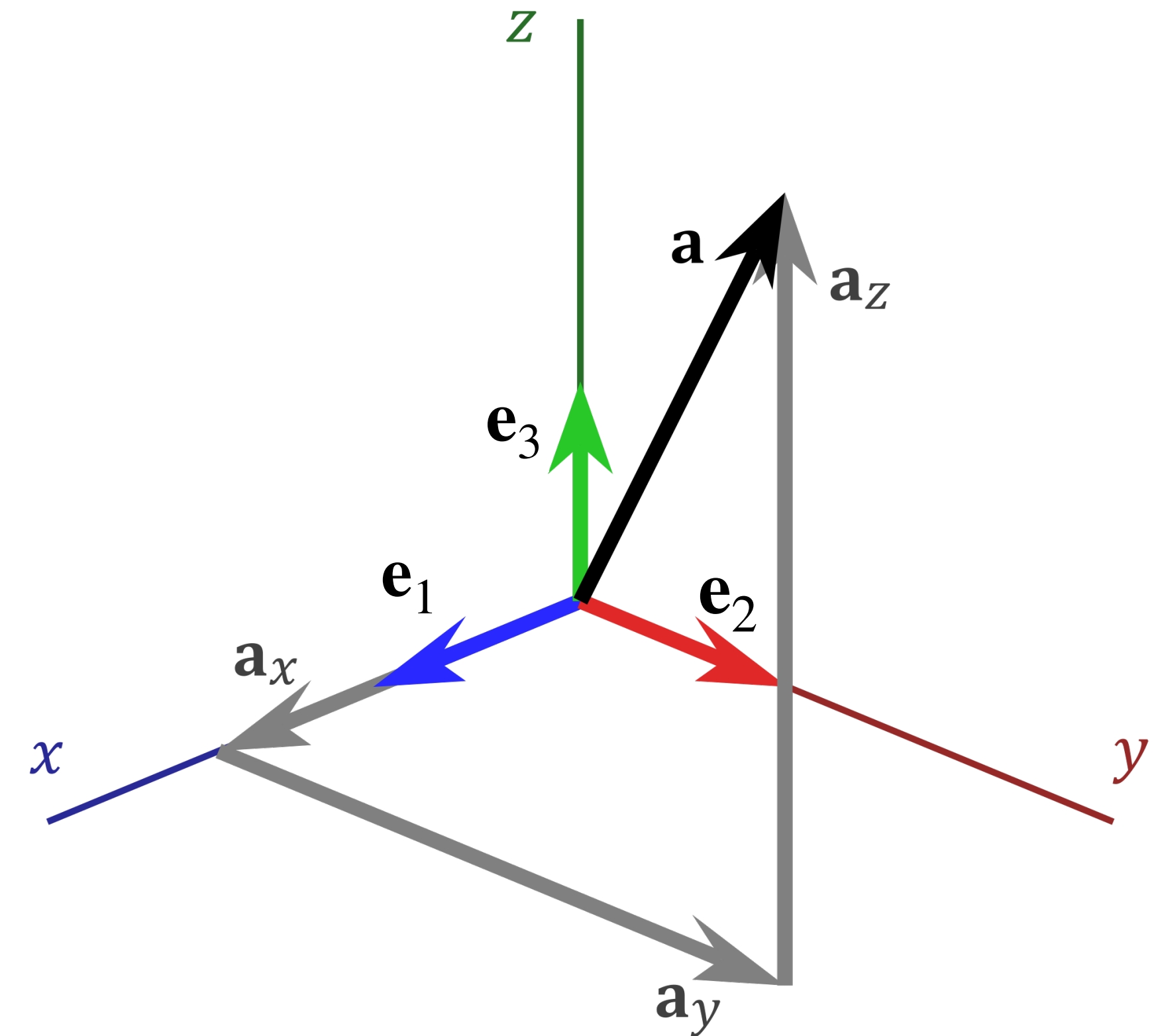


# Recall: Standard Basis

**Df.** The *n-dimensional standard basis vectors* (or standard coordinate vectors) are the vectors  $\mathbf{e}_1, \dots, \mathbf{e}_n$  where

$$\mathbf{e}_i = \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ 1 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \\ 0 \end{bmatrix} \begin{matrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ \vdots \\ i-1 \\ i \\ i+1 \\ \vdots \\ n-1 \\ n \end{matrix}$$

# What's special about the standard basis?

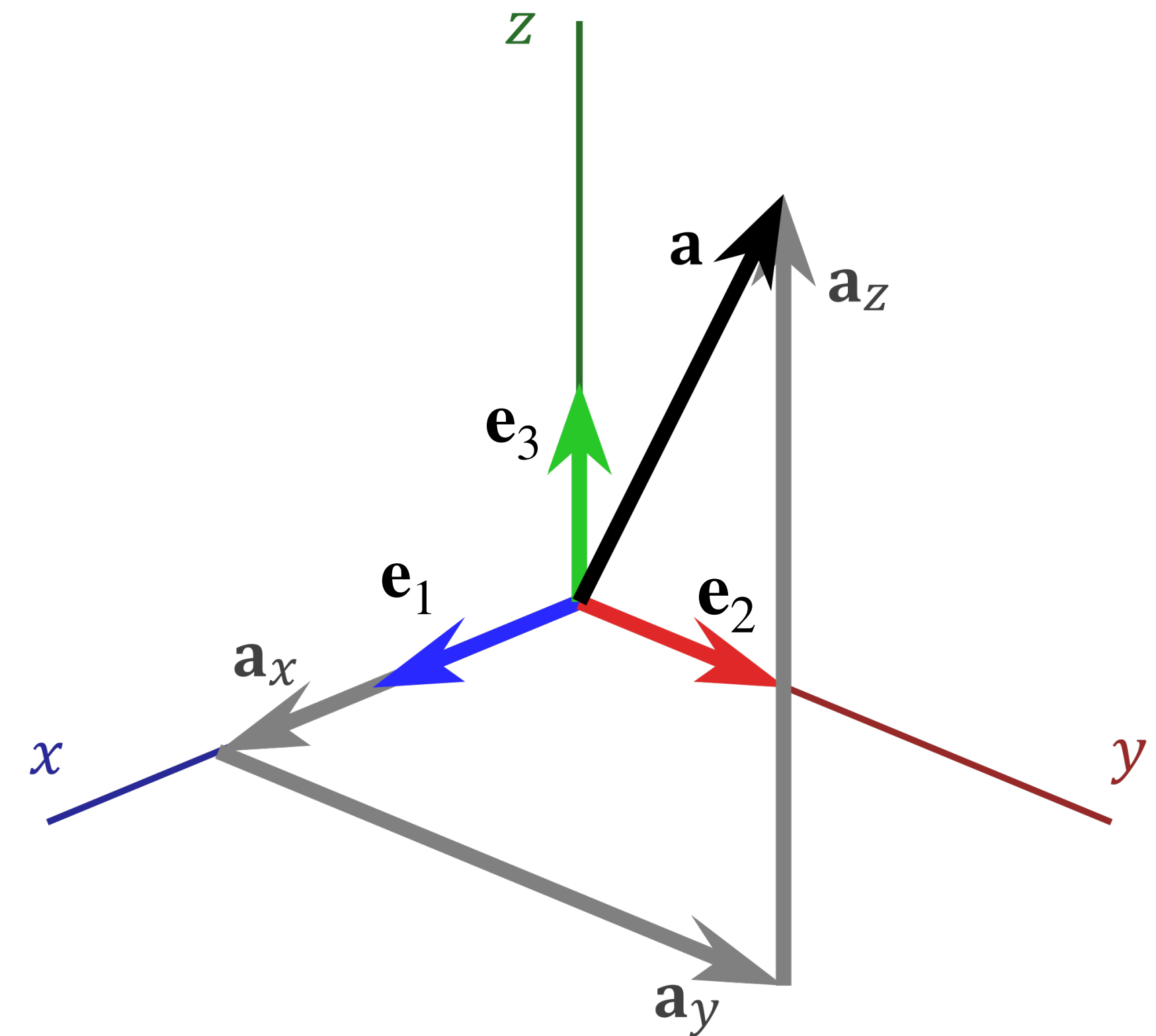




# What's special about the standard basis?

The  $n$  standard basis vectors  
in  $\mathbb{R}^n$ :

- » are linearly independent
- » span all of  $\mathbb{R}^n$

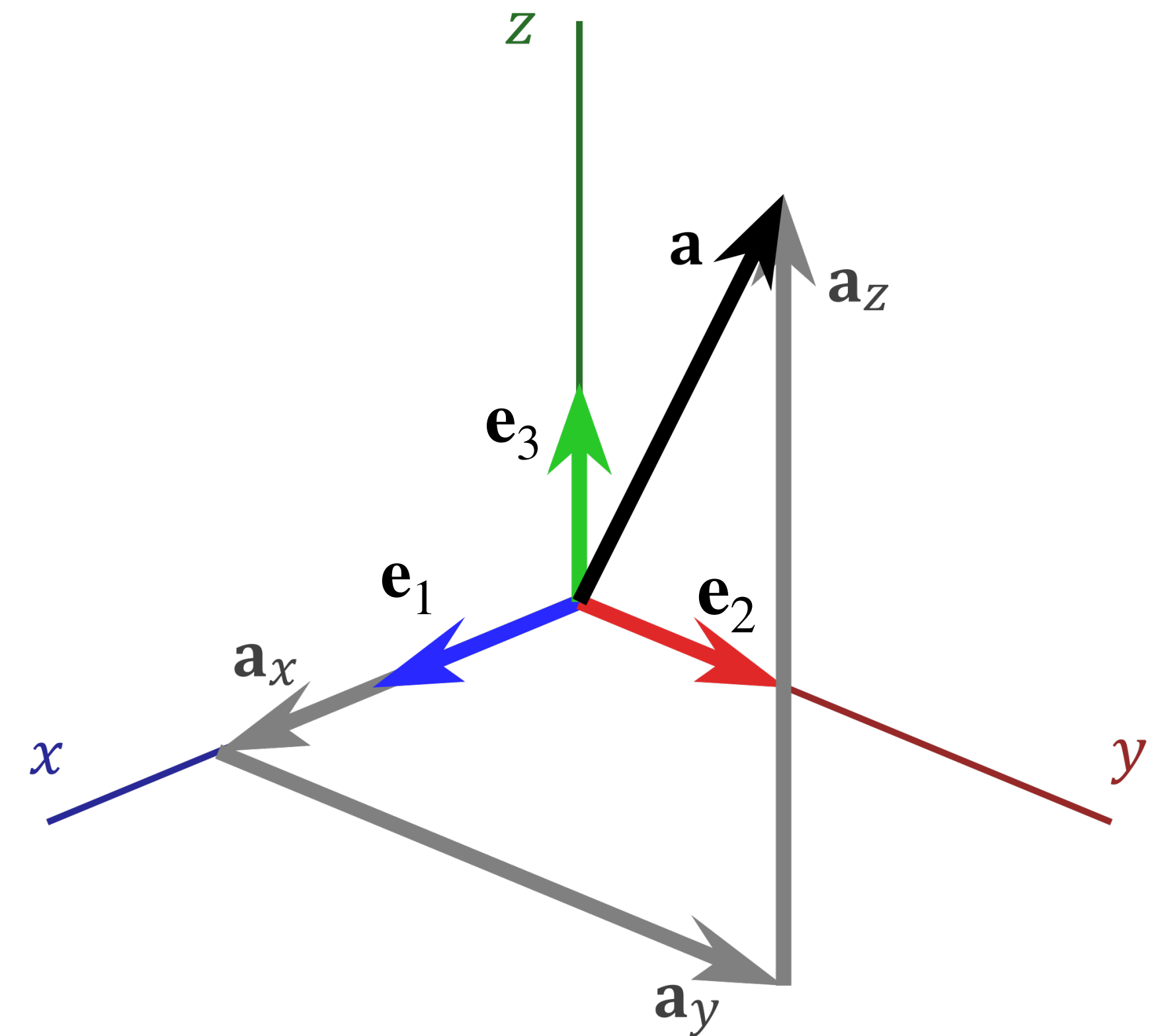


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Their span is as "large" as possible while the set of vectors generating the span is as "small" as possible



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**A basis is a *minimal* set of vectors which spans all of  $H$**

# Example: Standard basis

The standard basis is a basis of  $\mathbb{R}^n$

$$\begin{bmatrix} v_1 \\ v_2 \\ \vdots \\ v_n \end{bmatrix} = v_1 \mathbf{e}_1 + v_2 \mathbf{e}_2 + \dots + v_n \mathbf{e}_n$$

*Column vectors are just weights for a linear combination of the standard basis*



# Example: Column Space of Invertible Matrices

**Fact.** The columns of an invertible  $n \times n$  matrix form a basis of  $\mathbb{R}^n$

# Subsets of Spanning Sets



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We can *remove* vectors from a spanning set until we get a basis

**How do we do this?**

As usual, by connecting back to matrices

# Question

$$\left\{ \begin{bmatrix} 1 \\ 2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ -2 \\ -3 \end{bmatrix}, \begin{bmatrix} -1 \\ -2 \\ 3 \end{bmatrix} \right\}$$

*Is this set of vectors a basis for  $\mathbb{R}^3$ ?*

# **Bases of Column Space and Null Space**



# The Goal of this Last Section

Determine how to find bases for the **column space** and the **null space** of a given matrix

# How to: Finding a basis for the null space

Q. Given a  $m \times n$  matrix  $A$  find a basis for  $\text{Nul}(A)$



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Q. Given a  $m \times n$  matrix  $A$  find a basis for  $\text{Nul}(A)$

The idea. Describe the solutions of  $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$  as linear combination of vectors

# Example

$$A \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 0 & -1 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

Let's write down a general form solution for  $A$ :

# Parametric Solutions

We can think of our general form solution as a  
*linear transformation*

$$x_1 = 2x_2 + x_4 - 3x_5$$

$x_2$  is free

$$x_3 = (-2)x_4 + 2x_5$$

$x_4$  is free

$x_5$  is free

$\equiv$

"given values for  
 $x_2$ ,  $x_3$ , and  $x_4$ , I  
can give you a  
solution"



# Parametric Solutions

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$$\begin{bmatrix} s \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix} \mapsto \begin{bmatrix} 2s + t - 3u \\ s \\ (-2)t + 2u \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix}$$

# Parametric Solutions

We can think of our general form solution as a *linear transformation* !! this transformation is only linear !!  
!! in the case of homogeneous equations !!

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$$\begin{bmatrix} s \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix}$$

$\mapsto$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2s + t - 3u \\ s \\ (-2)t + 2u \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix}$$

# Example

$$\begin{bmatrix} s \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix} \mapsto \begin{bmatrix} 2s + t - 3u \\ s \\ (-2)t + 2u \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix}$$

Let's find the matrix implementing this transformation:



# Example

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & -3 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

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**The columns of this matrix span  $\text{Nul}(A)$**

# Example

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2 & 1 & -3 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -2 & 2 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

**Thm.** The columns of this matrix are linearly independent



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The columns of this matrix *span*  $\text{Nul}(A)$

The columns of this matrix are linearly independent

**The columns of this matrix form a basis for  $\text{Nul}(A)$**

# Example

Alternatively, we can write a general form solution so that it is a linear combination of vectors with *free variables as weights*

$$\begin{array}{l} x_1 = 2x_2 + x_4 - 3x_5 \\ x_2 \text{ is free} \\ x_3 = (-2)x_4 + 2x_5 \\ x_4 \text{ is free} \\ x_5 \text{ is free} \end{array}$$



# How to: Finding a basis for the null space

**Q.** Given a  $m \times n$  matrix  $A$  find a basis for  $\text{Nul}(A)$

**A.**

1. Find a general form solution for  $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$
2. Write this solution as a linear combination of vectors *where the free variables are the weights*
3. The resulting vectors form a basis for  $\text{Nul}(A)$

# An Observation

The *number* of vectors in the basis we found is the same as the number of *free variables* in a general form solution

$$x_1 = 2x_2 + x_4 - 3x_5$$

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$$x_3 = (-2)x_4 + 2x_5$$

$x_4$  is free

$x_5$  is free

$\equiv$

$$\begin{bmatrix} s \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix}$$

$\mapsto$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 2s + t - 3u \\ s \\ (-2)t + 2u \\ t \\ u \end{bmatrix}$$

# Practice Problem

$$A \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 7 \\ 0 & 1 & -3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

*Determine a basis for*  $\text{Nul}(A)$



**Answer**

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 7 \\ 0 & 1 & -3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$

onto column space...

# How To: Finding a basis for the column space



# How To: Finding a basis for the column space

**Question.** Given a  $m \times n$  matrix  $A$ , find a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

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# How To: Finding a basis for the column space

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So we also already know *some* subset of columns of  $A$  form a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

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So we also already know *some* subset of columns of  $A$  form a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

**Which vectors should we choose?**

# Column Space and Reduced Echelon form

$$[\mathbf{a}_1 \quad \mathbf{a}_2 \quad \mathbf{a}_3 \quad \mathbf{a}_4 \quad \mathbf{a}_5] \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 0 & -1 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & 2 & -2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$



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**The idea.** What if we cover up the non-pivot columns?

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Then we see  $[\mathbf{a}_1 \quad \mathbf{a}_3]$  has 2 pivots

# Column Space and Reduced Echelon form

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**The idea.** What if we cover up the non-pivot columns?

Then we see  $[\mathbf{a}_1 \quad \mathbf{a}_3]$  has 2 pivots

So the pivot columns are *linearly independent*



# Column Space and Reduced Echelon form

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# Column Space and Reduced Echelon form

$$\begin{bmatrix} \overset{2}{a_1} & \overset{1}{a_2} & \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare \end{bmatrix} \sim \begin{bmatrix} \overset{2}{1} & \overset{1}{-2} & \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare \\ 0 & 0 & \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare \\ 0 & 0 & \blacksquare & \blacksquare & \blacksquare \end{bmatrix}$$

**Observation.**  $[2 \ 1 \ 0 \ 0 \ 0]^T$  is a solution to the system  $A\mathbf{x} = \mathbf{0}$



# Column Space and Reduced Echelon form

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**In general, every non-pivot column of  $A$  can be written as a linear combination pivots in front of it**

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**In general, every non-pivot column of  $A$  can be written as a linear combination pivots in front of it**

This tells us that  $\mathbf{a}_1$  and  $\mathbf{a}_3$  *span*  $\text{Col}(A)$



# Column Space and Reduced Echelon form

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**The takeaway.** The pivot columns of  $A$  form a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

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**The takeaway.** The pivot columns of  $A$  form a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

**!! IMPORTANT !!**

**Choose the columns of  $A$**

*( $\mathbf{e}_1$  and  $\mathbf{e}_2$  do not necessarily form a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$ )*



# How To: Finding a basis for the column space

**Q.** Given a  $m \times n$  matrix  $A$ , find a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

**A.**

1. Find the pivot columns in an echelon form of  $A$
2. The associated columns in  $A$  form a basis for  $\text{Col}(A)$

# Question

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 19 & 0 & -4 \\ 1 & 0 & 9 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 & 14 & 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 9 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -5 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

*Find a bases for the column space and null space of  $A$*



**Answer**

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 1 & -2 & 19 & 0 & -4 \\ 1 & 0 & 9 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & -1 & 14 & 1 & -1 \end{bmatrix} \sim \begin{bmatrix} 1 & 0 & 9 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -5 & 0 & 2 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 1 \end{bmatrix}$$

# Summary

Subspaces define "tilted versions" of  $\mathbb{R}^k$  in  $\mathbb{R}^n$   
(where  $k \leq n$ )

Bases are compact representation of subspaces  
as minimal spanning sets

Matrices have useful associated subspaces like  
the column space and null space